Tanner Regan

Department of Economics
George Washington University
Room 310, Hall of Government
2115 G Street NW, Washington DC, 20052
+1(202) 994-3135

tannerregan.github.io
tanner_regan@gwu.edu
Google Scholar profile
Github profile

Academic Positions

2022–	Assistant Professor of Economics and International Affairs, George Washington University Parental Leave: *Fall 2023*, *Fall 2025*
2021–2022	Research Fellow, Department of Economics, London Business School

Affiliations

2025–	Research Affiliate, International Growth Centre
2022–	Affiliated Faculty, Institute for International Economic Policy, George Washington University
2021–	Associate, Centre for Economic Performance, London School of Economics
2020–	Affiliated Researcher, Wheeler Institute for Business and Development, London Business School

Education

2016–2021	PhD Economic Geography, London School of Economics
2013–2014	MA (Doctoral Stream) Economics, University of Toronto
2008–2013	BSc (Honours) Economics and Environmental Science, University of Toronto

Publications

Illuminating the Global South,
Chiovelli G., Michalopoulos S., Papaioannou E., and T. Regan, *Economic Journal*, forthcoming.

Ask a local: Improving the public pricing of land titles in urban Tanzania,
Manara M. and T. Regan, *Review of Economics and Statistics*, 107 (1):188–203, 2025.

Unbundling tenure security and demand for property rights: Evidence from urban Tanzania,
Manara M. and T. Regan, *Urban Studies*, 61(11), 2080-2098, 2024.

No Inventor Is an Island: Social Connectedness and the Geography of Knowledge Flows in the US,
Diemer A. and T. Regan, *Research Policy*, 51(2), article 104416, 2022.

Planning Ahead for Better Neighborhoods: Long Run Evidence from Tanzania,
Michaels G., D. Nigmatulina, F. Rauch, T. Regan, N. Baruah, and A. Dahlstrand, *Journal of Political Economy*, 129(7), pp. 2112–2156, 2021.

Building the city: from slums to a modern metropolis,
Henderson J.V., T. Regan, and A. Venables, *Review of Economic Studies*, 88(3), pp. 1157–1192, 2021.

Life in a slum: understanding living conditions in Nairobi's slums across time and space,
Bird J., P. Montebruno, and T. Regan, *Oxford Review of Economic Policy*, 33(3), pp. 496-520, 2017.

Building functional cities,
Henderson J.V., A. Venables, T. Regan, and I. Samsonov, *Science*, 352(6288), pp. 946-947, 2016.

Research (PI or co-PI) and Event Grants

2025	IGC, *In-situ rehousing in Kigali* (£39,927), with Juliana Oliveira-Cunha and Martina Manara
2025	GWU USS, *Data Science and Urban Governance* ($3,990)

2024 GWU USS, *Data Science and Urban Governance* ($4,000)
2024 IHS, *Sustainable Cities workshop series* ($5,000)
2024 IGC, *Progressive tax rate bands and the state of property tax in Kampala* (£10,043)
2023 IHS, *Thriving Cities workshop series* ($7,000), with Remi Jedwab
2023 IGC, *Spatial Construction Dynamics in Sites and Services Projects* (£69,963), with Vernon Henderson, Martina Manara, Guy Michaels, and Francisco Libano-Monteiro
2021 IGC, *Zoning laws and land value capture: Evidence from Rwanda* (£7,950), with Paul Brimble, Guy Michaels, and Matthew Sharp
2021 Wheeler Institute, *Improving the Effectiveness of Formal Housing Delivery in Tanzania* (£20,000), with Vernon Henderson, Martina Manara, and Guy Michaels
2021 IGC, *Exploring interactions between national and local government taxes* (£4,800), with Priya Manwaring
2020 IGC, *Public Reporting and Property Tax Compliance* (£65,000), with Priya Manwaring
2020 IDS, *Public Reporting and Property Tax Compliance* (£27,000), with Priya Manwaring
2019 IGC, *Valuation models for property tax* (£8,852), with Priya Manwaring
2019 IGC, *Public Reporting and Property Tax Compliance in Kampala* (£6,300), with Priya Manwaring
2018 IGC, *Leveraging Informal Institutions* (£19,491), with Martina Manara

External Presentations

Invited Seminars († planned)

2026 Nanyang Technological University†.
2025 University of Maryland AREC, HEC Lausanne.
2024 George Mason University Schar School, William & Mary, Syracuse University.
2023 University Pennsylvania Wharton, Institute for Fiscal Studies TaxDev.
2022 George Washington University, York University, University of Bristol.
2021 Paris Sorbonne, Nanyang Technological University, University Montevideo, University Toronto Munk School.

Conferences & Other (* discussant only, † planned, ‡ guest lecture)

2026 ASSA-AREUEA, WAMES, WADES*.
2025 World Bank Land Conference, National Tax Association, NEUDC, Wharton‡, GWU Women's Leadership Program GEB‡.
2024 16th Conference on Urban and Regional Economics (CURE), Harvard Cities and Development workshop, World Bank Land Conference, AREUEA National Conference, 11th WADES, 18th North American Meeting of the UEA, ASSA Conference*, JHU Cities and Development*, William & Mary‡, GWU Women's Leadership Program GEB‡.
2023 15th SIDEW at the Atlanta Fed, WB-GWU Urban Public Finance and Governance workshop, 10th WADES, William & Mary‡, AREUEA National Conference*, ASSA Conference*.
2022 World Bank Climate Change and Cities Workshop*.
2021 6th Zurich Conference on Public Finance in Developing Countries, IGC-DevLab@Duke cities workshop (faculty coach).
2020 Virtual meeting of the UEA.
2019 WEHIA at City University London, UREW at Universidad Javeriana.
2018 IDE-JETRO School, London School of Economics-NHH Conference.
2017 SERC Conference, IGC Making Cities Work, UEA Summer School, CEGA Geo4Dev Symposium.
2016 Land and Poverty Conference at the World Bank.
2015 Spatial Development of African Cities Workshop at the World Bank.

Professional Activities

Service to the Profession

2024–2026 Program committee member, North American Meeting of the Urban Economics Association.
2025 Program committee member, AREUEA National Meeting.
2024 Scientific committee member, 16th Conference on Urban and Regional Economics (CURE).

Referee Service

Quarterly Journal of Economics, *American Economic Review*, *Review of Economic Studies*, *AEJ: Applied Economics*, *Review of Economics and Statistics*, *Economic Journal*, *Journal of Urban Economics*, *Regional Science & Urban Economics*, *Journal of Public Economics*, *Journal of Development Economics*, *Journal of Economic Geography*, *Journal of Housing Economics*, *Journal of Econometrics*, *Journal of Environmental Economics and Management*, *World Development*.

University Service at GWU and ESIA

2026–	Member, Advisory Committee, GWU Department of Economics.
2023–	Co-organiser, GWU-WB Urbanization and Development Conference, hosted by; World Bank (2023, 2024), City of Cape Town (2025), SMU (2026).
2023–	Co-founder and organiser, Livable and Sustainable Cities Workshop Series, GWU ESIA and World Bank GP-URL.
2023–	Co-organiser, Washington Area Development Economics Symposium, hosted by; GWU-ESIA (2023), Georgetown (2024), GMU (2025), AU (2026).
2022–	Co-organiser, Trade and Development Seminar, GWU Economics and IIEP.
2022–2026	Chair, Organisation of the ESIA Dean's Seminar of African Economies.

PhD Advising

Jingwen Zheng (committee, 2026), Bozhen Liu (committee, 2023).

Teaching Experience

Course Instructor at George Washington University

2024–	ECON8351 Development Economics I (PhD)
2022–	ECON2151 Economic Development (undergraduate)

Workshop Instructor at London Business School

2022–2024	GIS for Quantitative Spatial Data Analysis (Open course)
2021	GIS Methods in Business Research (PhD)
2021	Geospatial Analytics for Business (MBA)

Teaching Assistant (GTA) at London School of Economics

2019–2020	GY210 The Economics of Cities (undergraduate)
2018	GY209 The Economic Geography of Trade, Production and Development (undergraduate)
2018	GY499 Dissertation Methods Surgeries (graduate)
2017–2018	GY201 Urban and Spatial Economic Analysis I (undergraduate)

Honors, Scholarships & Fellowships

2025	Goldfarb Prize for advancing economic research, GWU
2025	LSE Impact Prize for outstanding research culture
2019	David Jones Prize for inter-cluster research, Department of Geography and Environment, LSE
2016	PhD Studentship, LSE
2013	Doctoral Stream Fellowship, Department of Economics, University of Toronto
2012	T-Holder's Academic Excellence Award, University of Toronto
2010	Bronze T Award - Varsity Water Polo, University of Toronto
2008	Cmolik Foundation Scholarship

Previous Positions & Consulting

2019–2020	Data Science Consultant, Beekin
2014–2016	Research Assistant, Centre for Economic Performance, LSE
2012–2014	Research Assistant, Department of Economics, University of Toronto
2011–2012	Analyst, Environment Canada